

PLOT

1. Passage anchor

> “The **plot** is not wildly complicated, but it has a quiet emotional pull that kept me turning the pages.”

Passage meaning

plot = the connected series of events that make up the main story of a novel, film, play, etc.

情節；**故事情節**

Here, the speaker means that the sequence of events in *The Midnight Library* is relatively easy to follow.

Practice

1. The **plot** is simple, but the ideas behind it are quite deep.
故事**情節**很簡單，但背後的思想相當深刻。
2. The film has an interesting **plot** with several unexpected turns.
這部電影有很有趣的**情節**，其中有幾個出乎意料的轉折。

Core meanings of PLOT

2. plot — storyline

= the connected sequence of events that forms the story of a book, film, play, etc.

情節；**故事情節**

This is the exact passage sense.

Examples

1. The novel has a complicated **plot**.
這本小說的**情節**很複雜。
2. I enjoyed the characters more than the **plot**.
比起故事**情節**，我更喜歡那些角色。

3. plot development

= way in which a story's events progress and become more complex

****情節發展****

Examples

1. The ****plot development**** is quite slow at first.
一開始的****情節發展****相當緩慢。
2. Strong characters can make simple ****plot development**** more compelling.
出色的人物塑造能令簡單的****情節發展****更吸引人。

4. plot line / plotline

= particular sequence of events within a story

****故事線；情節線****

Examples

1. The film follows two separate ****plotlines****.
這部電影有兩條不同的****故事線****。
2. One ****plotline**** focuses on the family relationship.
其中一條****情節線****集中於家庭關係。

Secret plan / conspiracy

5. plot — secret plan

= secret plan by a group of people to do something illegal, harmful, or politically significant

****陰謀；密謀****

Examples

1. Police uncovered a ****plot**** to steal the documents.
警方揭發了一個偷取文件的****陰謀****。
2. The group was accused of taking part in a ****plot****.
該團體被指參與了一項****密謀****。

Major distinct noun sense.

6. plot against someone

= secretly plan to harm, remove, betray, or defeat someone

****密謀對付某人；暗算某人****

Examples

1. His enemies were ****plotting against him****.
他的敵人正在****密謀對付他****。
2. She suspected that several colleagues were ****plotting against her****.
她懷疑幾位同事正在****暗中對付她****。

7. plot to do something

= secretly plan to carry out a harmful or illegal action

****密謀做某事****

Examples

1. They ****plotted to overthrow**** the leader.
他們****密謀推翻****那名領袖。
2. The criminals ****plotted to steal**** the painting.
那些罪犯****密謀偷走****那幅畫。

Devise a plan

8. plot — plan carefully

= carefully plan a course of action, sometimes secretly

****策劃；謀劃****

This can be less sinister than the conspiracy sense, depending on context.

Examples

1. They ****plotted their next move**** carefully.
他們仔細****策劃下一步行動****。
2. She sat down to ****plot her route**** across the country.

她坐下來**規劃穿越全國的路線**。

9. plot a course

A. literally

= determine the route a ship, aircraft, etc. should take
規劃航線；標定航程

1. The captain **plotted a course** around the storm.
船長**規劃航線**繞過暴風雨。

B. figuratively

= decide a direction or strategy for future development
規劃方向；制定路線

2. The company is **plotting a course** for future growth.
公司正在為未來發展**規劃方向**。

Land

10. plot — piece of land

= small defined area of land used for a particular purpose
一塊土地；地皮；小片土地

Examples

1. They bought a small **plot of land**.
他們買了一小塊**土地**。
2. The house was built on a narrow **plot**.
房子建在一塊狹長的**地皮**上。

Major distinct concrete sense.

11. garden plot / vegetable plot

= small area of land used for growing plants or vegetables

****園圃；菜地****

Examples

1. She grows tomatoes in a small vegetable ****plot****.
她在一小塊****菜地****裡種番茄。
2. Each family was given a garden ****plot****.
每個家庭都獲分配一塊****園圃用地****。

12. burial plot

= piece of cemetery land reserved for a grave or graves
****墓地；墓穴用地****

Examples

1. The family purchased a ****burial plot****.
那個家庭購買了一塊****墓地****。
2. The cemetery had no additional ****plots**** available.
墓園沒有更多可用的****墓穴用地****。

Graph / chart

13. plot — graph showing data

= graph or diagram showing the relationship between variables or data points
****圖；數據圖；曲線圖****

Examples

1. The ****plot**** shows the relationship between temperature and pressure.
這張****圖****顯示溫度與壓力之間的關係。
2. Each point on the ****plot**** represents one observation.
圖上的每一個點代表一次觀測結果。

Important mathematical/scientific sense.

14. scatter plot

= graph consisting of separate points representing pairs of numerical values

****散點圖****

Examples

1. We displayed the results in a ****scatter plot****.
我們以****散點圖****呈現結果。
2. The ****scatter plot**** suggests a positive relationship.
****散點圖****顯示兩者可能呈正相關。

15. box plot

= statistical chart showing distribution using median, quartiles, etc.

****箱形圖；盒鬚圖****

Examples

1. The ****box plot**** shows the spread of the data.
****箱形圖****顯示數據的分布範圍。
2. Compare the two groups using a ****box plot****.
使用****箱形圖****比較兩組數據。

Verb: mark data on a graph

16. plot — mark a point on a graph

= place a point according to coordinates or values

****標出；繪出****

Examples

1. ****Plot the points**** on the graph.
把這些點****標在圖上****。
2. First, ****plot**** the value of x against y .
先把 x 與 y 的數值****繪在圖上****。

17. plot a graph / curve

= draw or generate a graphical representation from values or a function

****繪製圖表 / 曲線****

Examples

1. ****Plot a graph**** of distance against time.
****繪製**距離對時間的圖表。**
2. The software can ****plot the curve**** automatically.
軟體可以自動****繪製曲線****。

Map / position

18. plot — mark a location on a map

= mark the exact position of something on a map or chart

****在地圖上標示位置；標定****

Examples

1. They ****plotted the locations**** on a map.
他們在地圖上****標出了這些位置****。
2. The coordinates were ****plotted**** carefully.
這些座標被仔細****標定****。

19. plot a route

= mark or plan a route on a map

****規劃 / 標示路線****

Examples

1. We ****plotted the route**** before leaving.
我們出發前先****規劃好路線****。
2. The software ****plots the fastest route****.
軟體會****繪出最快路線****。

Story construction

20. plot — devise a fictional storyline

= plan the events and structure of a novel, film, etc.

****設計情節；構思故事****

Examples

1. She carefully ****plotted the novel**** before writing it.
她在動筆前仔細****構思了小說情節****。
2. The story is tightly ****plotted****.
這個故事的****情節設計十分緊密****。

Useful bridge between the noun “storyline” and verb “plan.”

21. well-plotted

= having a carefully structured and effective storyline

****情節設計周密的****

Examples

1. It is a clever, ****well-plotted**** mystery.
這是一部聰明而且****情節設計周密的****推理作品。
2. The novel is beautifully written and tightly ****plotted****.
這本小說文筆優美，而且****情節結構緊密****。

Related forms

22. plotter

A. person involved in a secret plot

****陰謀者；密謀者****

1. The ****plotters**** were arrested.
那些****密謀者****被捕了。

B. device that produces large precise drawings

****繪圖機****

2. The architect printed the plan on a ****plotter****.

建築師用****繪圖機****印出了圖則。

A useful family member with genuine polysemy.

23. plotting

A. secret planning

****密謀；策劃****

1. They were accused of ****plotting**** against the government.

他們被指控****密謀****對抗政府。

B. constructing a story

****情節構思****

2. Good ****plotting**** keeps the story coherent.

良好的****情節構思****能令故事保持連貫。

C. graphing

****繪圖；標點****

3. Data ****plotting**** can reveal patterns.

****數據繪圖****可以顯示模式。

High-value expressions

24. the plot thickens

= a situation becomes more complicated, mysterious, or interesting

****事情變得更複雜 / 更撲朔迷離了****

Examples

1. A second letter appeared—and **the plot thickened**.

第二封信出現了，事情開始**變得更撲朔迷離**。

2. Now we know they already knew each other. **The plot thickens.**

現在我們知道他們原來早已認識。**事情越來越複雜了。**

Originally story-related, now very common figuratively.

25. lose the plot

Primarily BrE informal.

A. become confused and unable to understand what is happening

搞不清楚狀況；失去頭緒

1. Halfway through the explanation, I completely **lost the plot**.

解釋到一半時，我完全**搞不清楚狀況了**。

B. behave irrationally / lose emotional control

失去理智；失控

2. He seemed to **lose the plot** during the argument.

他在爭吵中似乎**失去了理智**。

26. plot twist

= unexpected change in the direction or understanding of a story

情節反轉；劇情轉折

Examples

1. The final **plot twist** surprised everyone.

最後的**情節反轉**令所有人都很驚訝。

2. The film depends on one major **plot twist**.

這部電影主要靠一個重大的**劇情轉折**推動。

In your passage, **twist** itself is another high-value polysemy word.

27. plot hole

= inconsistency or logical gap in a fictional storyline

****情節漏洞****

Examples

1. The ending creates a major ****plot hole****.

結局造成了一個很大的****情節漏洞****。

2. Viewers noticed several ****plot holes****.

觀眾發現了幾個****劇情漏洞****。

Useful established compound.

Key contrasts

28. plot vs story

****story****

= entire narrative: characters, setting, events, meaning, etc.

****故事****

****plot****

= organized sequence of events and how they connect

****情節****

Compare:

> The ****story**** is about regret.

> 故事是關於後悔。

> The ****plot**** follows a woman entering different versions of her life.

> 情節描寫一名女子進入不同人生版本。

29. plot vs storyline

****storyline****

= sequence of events in a story, often one strand among several

****故事線****

****plot****

= overall organized structure of the events

****情節****

They often overlap.

30. plot vs theme

****plot****

= what happens

****情節****

****theme****

= underlying idea explored by the work

****主題****

For this passage:

> ****plot****

> → Nora enters different possible lives

> ****themes****

> → regret, choices, meaning, perfect life

This distinction is especially important for literary comprehension.

31. plot vs plan

****plan****

= general arrangement for doing something

****計畫****

****plot****

= when used for planning, often suggests detailed strategy and may imply secrecy or harmful intent

****策劃 ; 密謀****

Compare:

> plan a holiday

> 計畫假期

> plot a robbery

> 密謀搶劫

32. plot vs conspiracy

****plot****

= secret plan to do something harmful or illegal

****陰謀****

****conspiracy****

= secret agreement between several people to commit an unlawful or harmful act

****共謀 ; 陰謀****

A ****plot**** emphasizes the plan; a ****conspiracy**** emphasizes the people secretly agreeing and working together.

33. plot vs graph

****graph****

= broad visual representation of mathematical or numerical relationships

****圖表 ; 圖形****

****plot****

= may mean the graph itself, or the act of placing data points on it

****數據圖 ; 繪圖****

Compare:

> look at the graph

> 查看圖表

> plot the data

> 把數據繪在圖上

34. plot vs chart

****chart****

= broad visual display of data or information

****圖表****

****plot****

= especially a representation based on points, coordinates, or numerical relationships

****繪圖；數據圖****

Meaning map

The major senses of ****plot**** divide into several clearly different branches:

Story

the plot of a novel

→ ****小說情節****

Secret plan

a plot to overthrow someone

→ ****陰謀****

Careful planning

plot your next move

→ ****策劃下一步****

Land

a plot of land

→ ****一塊土地****

Statistics

a scatter plot

→ ****散點圖****

Mathematics

plot a point

→ ****標出座標點****

Mapping

plot a route

→ ****標示 / 規劃路線****

These senses connect historically through ideas of ****marking out, arranging, and planning****, but

for learners they should be kept clearly separate.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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plot — story	小說、電影、戲劇等中互相連接的一系列故事事件；情節
plot development	故事情節逐步推進、發展的過程
plotline	故事中的一條情節線 / 故事線
plot — secret plan	為做非法、有害等事情而秘密制定的陰謀 / 計畫
plot against someone	密謀傷害、推翻或對付某人
plot to do something	密謀進行某種通常有害或非法的行動
plot — plan carefully	仔細策劃、謀劃行動或未來步驟
plot a course — literal	規劃船舶、飛機等的航線
plot a course — figurative	為未來制定方向 / 發展路線
plot — land	有明確界線的一小塊土地 / 地皮
garden/vegetable plot	用來種植花卉、蔬菜等的小塊土地
burial plot	墓園中用作埋葬的墓地 / 墓穴用地
plot — graph	表示數據或變數關係的圖
scatter plot	以數據點顯示兩個數值變數關係的散點圖
box plot	顯示中位數、四分位數及數據分布的箱形圖
plot — mark points	按座標 / 數值把點標在圖上
plot a graph/curve	根據數值或函數繪製圖形 / 曲線
plot — map position	把某物的位置標記在地圖或海圖上
plot a route	在地圖上規劃 / 標示一條路線
plot — construct story	預先設計、安排小說或電影的情節
well-plotted	故事情節安排周密、結構良好的
plotter — conspirator	參與陰謀的人；密謀者
plotter — machine	用來輸出大型精確圖形的繪圖機
the plot thickens	情況變得更複雜、更神秘 / 更撲朔迷離
lose the plot	搞不清楚狀況；亦可指失去理智 / 失控
plot twist	故事中出乎意料、改變發展方向的情節反轉
plot hole	故事情節中不合邏輯或無法解釋的漏洞

Passage recap

> “The **plot** is not wildly complicated, but it has a quiet emotional pull that kept me turning the pages.”

Here:

plot = the connected sequence and structure of events in a fictional story

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **情節**

* **故事情節**

Natural contextual translation:

這個故事的情節不算特別複雜，但它有一種安靜而持續的情感牽引力，讓我一直想讀下去。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

plot

= **the series of connected events that form the main action of a novel, film, play, etc.**

情節；故事情節

The most important learner distinctions are:

> **plot of a novel**

> → 小說**情節**

> **a criminal plot**

> → 犯罪**陰謀**

> **a plot of land**

> → 一塊**土地**

> **a scatter plot**

> → **散點圖**

> **plot the points**

> → 把點**標在圖上**

So **plot** is a particularly valuable MCQ word: the same form can move from **literature → conspiracy → land → mathematics/data visualization** with genuinely different meanings.